



Live Project Briefs

Equity Research & Financial Modeling Analyst

1 project curated for the Finance track.

Role	Equity Research & Financial Modeling Analyst
Projects	1

A light, structured handbook for understanding expectations, planning work, and preparing the final live project submission.



PROJECT TOOLKIT

Live Project Guidelines

Core guidance students should review before working on any live project.

General Guidelines for Live Projects

1. **Individual or Group Participation:** Students may complete the project individually or form a group of up to **four (4) members**. Group formation is entirely at the students' discretion; however, **all group members must belong to the same college/institution**.
2. **Weekly Project Reviews:** Students are expected to attend and follow the instructions, guidance, and action items shared by the Project Manager during the weekly live project review sessions.
3. **Self-Paced Learning:** This is a **self-paced Live Project**, and no strict weekly deadlines have been assigned to accommodate students' academic commitments. However, students are strongly encouraged to maintain consistent progress and actively participate throughout the project to maximize their learning experience.
4. **Recommended Time Commitment:** Students should dedicate approximately **2-3 hours per week** to successfully complete the project and achieve the intended learning outcomes.
5. **Project Report Submission:** Upon completion of the project, students must prepare a comprehensive **Project Report** in either **Microsoft Word (.doc/.docx)** or **PowerPoint (.ppt/.pptx)** format for evaluation. There is **no prescribed page or slide limit**. Students are encouraged to demonstrate originality and creativity by designing their own report structure and presentation format.
6. **Project Completion & Certificate:** There is **no fixed deadline** for submitting the Live Project report. Students may submit their project at any time after completing all the required work. Upon successful evaluation, the **Live Project Completion Certificate** will generally be issued within **3-4 working days**.
7. **Project Selection:** Students may choose **any one of the available Live Projects**. Those enrolled in multiple project roles may either work on all projects simultaneously or complete them sequentially, based on their convenience.
8. **Group Submission Policy:** For group projects, all team members must work on a common project report. However, **each member is required to submit the report individually through their own LMS account** to be eligible for evaluation and certification.
9. **Submission Process:** **All project submissions will be accepted exclusively through the LMS Portal**. Reports submitted via email, WhatsApp, Google Drive links, or any other platform will **not** be considered for evaluation.



PROJECT TOOLKIT

How to Start your Project (4-week Framework)

Suggested weekly rhythm for planning, analysis, drafting, and final submission.

Week-wise Roadmap for Live Project Completion

Important Note

The following roadmap is a **recommended four-week learning framework** designed to help students approach the Live Project in a structured and industry-oriented manner.

Since this is a **self-paced project**, students who wish to complete the project earlier are welcome to do so. However, they are **strongly advised to follow the same sequence of activities (Week 01 -> Week 02 & 03 -> Week 04)** to ensure a systematic learning experience.

Students may accelerate the pace of execution but **should not skip or rearrange any stage of the project workflow**, as each phase builds the foundation for the next.

Week 01 - Market Research & Company Understanding

Objective

The objective of Week 1 is to develop a comprehensive understanding of the company, industry, customers, and business environment before beginning the project execution.

1. Project Selection

- Review the list of available Live Projects under your selected role.
- Select one project that you wish to work on as your Live Project.

2. Company & Market Research

Conduct detailed research on the company from multiple functional perspectives to develop cross-functional business thinking. This will help you understand how different business functions contribute to solving real-world problems.

Your research should include:

- Understanding the company's objectives and core offerings
- Company Analysis
- Product & Service Analysis



- Website Analysis
- Website User Experience (UX) Analysis
- Customer Segment Analysis
- Competitor Analysis

3. Business Framework Analysis

Based on your research findings, apply relevant business and strategic frameworks to understand the company's current position and future opportunities.

Suggested frameworks include:

- SWOT Analysis
- PESTEL Analysis
- Ansoff Matrix
- Any other relevant strategic framework applicable to your project

4. Digital Landscape Research

Evaluate the company's online presence and digital positioning by conducting research on:

- Official website and digital assets
- Social media platforms
- Brand visibility and customer engagement
- Existing marketing strategies
- Competitor social media analysis
- Market gaps and potential opportunities

Week 02 & Week 03 - Project Execution & Deliverables

Objective

The objective of this phase is to solve the assigned business problem by applying your research findings and analytical skills.

Students should:

- Work on the project objectives and deliverables specified for their selected Live Project.
- Perform additional market research wherever required.



- Conduct data analysis and interpret findings.
- Brainstorm and evaluate multiple solution approaches.
- Develop practical, research-backed recommendations.
- Continuously refine the project based on insights generated throughout the execution phase.

This stage should focus on demonstrating:

- Problem-solving ability
- Strategic thinking
- Practical business recommendations

Week 04 - Final Recommendations & Project Report Submission

Objective

The final week should focus on consolidating all your work into a professional project report.

Students should:

- Prepare the final project report in either **Microsoft Word (.doc/.docx)** or **PowerPoint (.ppt/.pptx)** format.
- Organize the report in a logical and professional manner.
- Compile all research findings, analyses, project outcomes, and supporting evidence.
- Present actionable business recommendations and implementation strategies.
- Review and proofread the report before submission through the **LMS Portal**.

The final report should clearly demonstrate:

- Research methodology
- Analytical thinking
- Business understanding
- Recommendations
- Overall project outcomes



EQUITY RESEARCH & FINANCIAL MODELING ANALYST

Project Details

Project 1

Equity Valuation & Financial Modeling

Company	Skilled Sapiens
Role Category	Finance

Project Brief

As part of this live project, participants will undertake a comprehensive equity research and valuation assignment on **Dabur India Ltd.** using only publicly available information, with the company's official Annual Reports serving as the primary source for historical financial data.

Participants will begin by analysing the company's historical performance, management commentary, and industry environment before manually compiling five years of consolidated financial statements into a dynamic Excel-based financial model. Based on their research and financial analysis, they will prepare forecasts, estimate the company's intrinsic value using appropriate valuation techniques, compare the company with its peers through relative valuation, and evaluate the key drivers influencing business performance and valuation.

The project concludes with the preparation of a professional investment research report summarizing the participant's analysis, observations, valuation findings, risks, and final investment recommendation. Together, the Excel financial model and supporting report will demonstrate the participant's ability to conduct a structured equity research assignment comparable to those performed in professional finance and investment roles.

Objectives

The primary objective of this live project is to enable participants to gain hands-on experience in equity valuation by applying theoretical concepts to a real-world business case.

Upon completion of this project, participants should be able to:

- Understand a company's business model, industry dynamics, and competitive landscape.
- Analyse historical financial statements and identify key business trends.
- Build a dynamic three-statement financial model using historical financial data.
- Develop realistic forecasting assumptions supported by research and business rationale.
- Perform intrinsic valuation using Discounted Cash Flow (DCF) methodologies.



- Calculate the Cost of Equity and Weighted Average Cost of Capital (WACC).
- Conduct sensitivity analysis to evaluate key valuation drivers.
- Perform relative valuation using industry valuation multiples.
- Interpret financial ratios and derive meaningful business insights.
- Present investment recommendations through a structured professional research report.
- Develop practical financial modeling and valuation skills aligned with industry best practices.

Action Items

Introduction

The **Certification in Equity Valuation & Financial Modeling** Live Project is designed to provide participants with practical exposure to the end-to-end equity research and valuation process followed by investment banks, equity research firms, private equity firms, consulting organizations, and institutional investors.

Throughout this project, participants will work on a real listed company and apply industry-standard financial analysis techniques to understand its business model, competitive positioning, financial performance, and intrinsic value. The project emphasizes a research-driven approach, requiring participants to collect information from authentic sources, build dynamic financial models, perform valuation, and formulate an evidence-based investment recommendation.

By successfully completing this project, participants will develop the analytical, technical, and decision-making skills required for careers in Equity Research, Investment Banking, Corporate Finance, Asset Management, and Financial Consulting.

Deliverables

Live Project Scope of Work in Equity Valuation & Financial Modeling:

As part of this live project, you are required to conduct a comprehensive equity research and valuation exercise on **Dabur India Ltd.** The objective of this project is to help you develop practical skills in financial statement analysis, industry research, financial modeling, valuation, and investment recommendation.

Project Deliverables:

1. Annual Report Collection

- Download the **latest five years' Annual Reports** of **Dabur India Ltd.**
- Only the official Annual Reports published by the company should be used throughout this project.

2. Management Discussion & Analysis (MD&A)



- Carefully review the **Management Discussion & Analysis (MD&A)** section of each of the last five Annual Reports.
- Summarize the key management insights, strategic initiatives, industry trends, risks, opportunities, and future outlook highlighted over the five-year period.
- Prepare concise observations on how the company's strategy and business environment have evolved.

3. Historical Financial Statement Compilation

- Extract the **Consolidated Financial Statements** for the last five financial years directly from the Annual Reports.
- Manually populate all historical financial data into your Excel model.
- **Important:** No third-party financial databases or websites are permitted.

The use of platforms such as:

- Moneycontrol
- Screener
- CMIE
- ACE Equity
- Tickertape
- Trendlyne
- Any other financial database will **not** be accepted. Every figure must be sourced directly from the company's published Annual Reports.

4. Industry Analysis

Conduct a detailed analysis of the industry in which Dabur operates. Your analysis should include, but is not limited to, the following:

- Apply **Porter's Five Forces Framework** and evaluate the competitive dynamics of the industry.
- Estimate the current size of the industry and its expected growth potential.
- Identify the major competitors and estimate their respective market shares.
- Explain the business models of leading companies in the industry.
- Compare operating margins and profitability across major players.
- Assess the overall market opportunity in India.
- Identify and explain the major revenue drivers and cost drivers influencing the business.



- Support your observations with logical reasoning and relevant research.

5. Financial Model Development

Prepare a fully dynamic **Three-Statement Financial Model** in Microsoft Excel.

The model should:

- Link the Income Statement, Balance Sheet, and Cash Flow Statement correctly.
- Maintain complete formula integrity.
- Automatically update financial statements when assumptions are changed.
- Follow best practices in financial modeling.

6. Forecast Assumptions

Prepare detailed forecasting assumptions covering all major operating and financial line items.

For each assumption:

- Clearly explain the rationale.
- Support assumptions using historical trends, industry outlook, management commentary, or logical reasoning.

7. Valuation Methodology Selection

Determine the appropriate valuation approach.

You should:

- Decide whether **FCFF (Free Cash Flow to Firm)** or **FCFE (Free Cash Flow to Equity)** is more appropriate.
- Clearly justify your selection based on the company's characteristics and capital structure.

8. Cost of Capital Calculation

Calculate the appropriate discount rate.

Depending on your chosen valuation methodology, compute:

- Cost of Equity
- Weighted Average Cost of Capital (WACC)

Include all workings, assumptions, formulas, and sources used in the calculation.



9. Intrinsic Valuation

Perform a complete Discounted Cash Flow (DCF) valuation.

Your valuation should include:

- Forecast period
- Terminal value calculation
- Discounting methodology
- Enterprise Value
- Equity Value
- Intrinsic Value per Share

Clearly explain your methodology and interpretation of the results.

10. Sensitivity Analysis

Perform sensitivity analysis to evaluate the impact of key assumptions on valuation.

Identify the variables that have the greatest influence on intrinsic value, such as:

- Revenue Growth
- EBITDA Margin
- Terminal Growth Rate
- WACC / Discount Rate

Present the findings using appropriate sensitivity tables or charts.

11. Relative Valuation

Conduct a peer comparison using commonly used valuation multiples, including:

- Price-to-Earnings (P/E)
- Price-to-Sales (P/S)
- EV / EBITDA

Compare Dabur with its listed peers and interpret whether the company appears relatively overvalued, undervalued, or fairly valued.

12. Financial Ratio Analysis



Calculate and analyse relevant financial ratios, including:

- Profitability Ratios
- Liquidity Ratios
- Efficiency Ratios
- Solvency Ratios
- Return Ratios

Interpret the trends over the historical period and provide meaningful business insights.

13. Investment Recommendation Report

Prepare a professional report of **at least five pages** summarizing your complete analysis.

The report should include:

- Executive Summary
- Company Overview
- Industry Analysis
- Financial Performance Analysis
- Valuation Summary
- Key Risks
- Investment Recommendation (Buy / Hold / Sell)
- Conclusion

Your report should focus on insights, interpretation, and recommendations rather than reproducing raw financial data.

Final Submission Requirements:

You are required to submit either of the following:

1. Microsoft Excel Financial Model

The Excel workbook should include:

- Historical Financial Statements
- Dynamic Three-Statement Model



- Forecast Assumptions
- DCF Valuation
- Sensitivity Analysis
- Relative Valuation
- Financial Ratio Analysis

2. Supporting Report (Word/PDF)

The accompanying report should primarily focus on:

- Observations
- Analysis
- Interpretation
- Business insights
- Final recommendation

The report should **not** duplicate the numerical schedules already presented in the Excel model. Instead, it should explain the rationale behind your analysis and highlight the key findings that support your investment recommendation.